

IK 521: Connecting Indian Music with Life

Course Code: IK 521

Course Name: Connecting Indian Music with Life

L-T-P-C: 2-1-2-4

Prerequisites: None

Intended for: M.A/ B. Tech/MTech/MS/MSc/PhD

Mutual Exclusion: There are no equivalent or overlapping courses across schools.

Approval: 64th BoA

Preamble

This course explores the inherent connections between Indian music, nature, life and values, in an attempt to bridge Indian musical knowledge systems (passed on through Guru-Shishya Parampara) with contemporary understandings of emotion, cognition, wellbeing, creativity and holistic human lived experience. Through a balance of theory, tutorials and intensive experiential practice, students are expected to see Indian music not merely as a performance training, but as a transformative medium connecting sound, self, society and consciousness.

Course Modules

- **Module 1: Indian Music, Nature, Human Values and Life:**

- Music as a way of life in Indian tradition – Connection to Indian Philosophies
- *Guru–Shishya Paramparā* and holistic learning
- Music, nature and the five elements
- Human qualities and values in music learning: concentration, discipline, humility, acceptance, love, empathy, surrender
- Uniqueness of Indian music:
 - * monophonic and vocal orientation
 - * *meend* and continuity
 - * cyclicity
 - * improvisation
 - * intuition
- Music as self-discovery and inner development

- **Module 2: Sound & Breath, Long-Note Practice and Tānpurā:**

- Acoustics and psychoacoustics of Indian music
- Role of Sā and tonal reference
- Tānpurā as the “Mother of Indian Music”
- Difference between Indian natural shrutis and equally-tempered scale
- Long-note practice with Aumkār and five different vowels: concentration, breath control, improving resonance, mindfulness
- Importance of Dynamics modulation and its practice
- Neurocognitive and therapeutic implications of drone and sustained tones

- Music, respiration and attention regulation
- **Module 3: Sur Darshan and Tāl Darshan: Visualization, Embodiment and Creativity:**
 - Concept of Sur vs Swar
 - Visualization-oriented pedagogy
 - Synesthetic and embodied learning approaches
 - Sur Darshan: imagining melodic movement as painting on air with air
 - Tāl Darshan: visualizing laya, chhanda and tāl as painting on time
 - Kinaesthetic cognition in Indian rhythm
 - Conscious vs habitual practice
 - Role of improvisation in creativity development
 - Cognitive science of musical visualization
- **Module 4: Kāvya, Rāga and Emotional Communication through their Bonding:**
 - Kāvya Darshan and lyrical visualization
 - Bhāva and emotional communication
 - Relationship between lyrics, melody and rhythm
 - Lexical and non-lexical features of rāga
 - *Meend, andolan, nyās, sparsha* and rāga personality
 - Improvisation and emotional nuance
 - Music, memory and affective processing
- **Module 5: Indian Music, Wellbeing and Contemporary Applications:**
 - Indian music and mindfulness
 - Music, cognition and emotional wellbeing
 - Music and mental health applications
 - Music for social harmony and world peace
 - Introduction to music-based therapeutic thinking
 - Contemporary interdisciplinary applications: learning & memory – education, emotional regulation and various other therapy, neuroscience, wellbeing, community engagement

Tutorial/Practical Components

- **Module 1:** Guided reflective listening sessions, Group discussions on music-life experiences, Voice-body awareness exercises, Introduction to mindful listening with tānpurā drone, Observation journal/Reflective Diary: “Music and Everyday Emotional Experience”, Comparative listening analysis: Hindustani, Carnatic, Various Indian devotional and folk and selected world traditions; Group presentation on Music, nature and life. Take home assignments on exploring these connectivities.
- **Module 2:** Daily long-note practice, Aumkār and vowel resonance exercises, Sound and Breath control with beats, Tānpurā playing and tuning demonstrations, Loudness modulation exercises, Voice projection and stability training, Recording and self-analysis of sustained-note practice. Take home assignments on sound, breath and mind connections.

- **Module 3:** Melodic visualization exercises, Simple one-way pattern and reverse-pattern pālā practice, Beat visualization with hand gestures, multi-sensory rhythm exercises, Metronome-based tempo awareness, Group improvisation exercises, Rhythmic movement and mind-body coordination, Creation of visual melodic maps. Take home assignments on sur & tāl darshan.
- **Module 4:** Lyric interpretation exercises (Reading lyrics without & with melody) with songs of different genres – classical, devotional, folk, singing with emotional modulation, Comparative rāga mood analysis, Bandish learning with expressive phrasing, Improvisation maintaining rāga bhāva, Group discussions on emotional perception in music, Emotion-analysis presentation, Analysis of general vs. reflective performance. Take home assignments on rāga bhava and kāvya bhava connectivity.
- **Module 5:** Designing music-based wellbeing exercises (in the form of mini research/project), Community or classroom-based demonstrations, Guided relaxation using rāga and Tānpurā drone, Applied music intervention models, Final integrative practical presentation. Take home assignments like experiment designing, data collection and analysis and mini-project presentations.

Text Books

- a. *Shrutinandan* by Ajoy Chakrabarty, Macmillan Publishers India Ltd., 2002.
- b. *Finding the Raga: An Improvisation on Indian Music* by Amit Chaudhuri, Penguin Hamish Hamilton Publishers, 2021.

References

- a. Saarikallio, S., Alluri, V., Maksimainen, J., & Toiviainen, P. (2021). Emotions of music listening in Finland and in India: Comparison of an individualistic and a collectivistic culture. *Psychology of Music*, 49(4), 989-1005.
- b. Valla, J. M., Alappatt, J. A., Mathur, A., & Singh, N. C. (2017). Music and emotion—a case for north indian classical music. *Frontiers in psychology*, 8, 2115.
- c. *Natyastra of Bharatmuni* (Vol. 1,2,3,4) Sanskrit Text with Abhinavabharati commentary (Sanskrit Edition), Editor R. S. Nagar, Parimal Publications Delhi, 2012.
- d. *Hindustani Sangeet Paddhati Kramik Pustak Malika* (Part 1 to 6) by Pandit Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande and Harishchandra Shrivastava, Sangeet Sadan Prakashan, 2022
- e. *Music Revisited: The Shrutinandan Way* by Ajoy Chakrabarty, (with publishers)